

PAN Card Tutorial

Finance • Online • Estimated time: 20 min

Overview

PAN is a 10-character alphanumeric identifier used for all tax and high-value financial transactions. Instant e-PAN is issued free through Aadhaar-based e-KYC; physical cards are issued through NSDL or UTIITSL.

Eligibility

- Indian citizens, NRIs, and foreign nationals transacting in India
- Aadhaar with a linked mobile number for instant e-PAN
- Applicant must not already hold a PAN

Required Documents

- Aadhaar card — 12-digit number. Mandatory for instant e-PAN.
- Registered mobile number — SMS OTP. Used for Aadhaar e-KYC.
- Proof of date of birth — PDF / JPG. Birth certificate, matriculation certificate.
- Passport-size photo — JPG, under 300 KB. Only for physical card applications.

Charges & Timeline

Government fee: ₹107

Service charge: e-PAN via Aadhaar is free

Processing time: 10 minutes (e-PAN) · 15 days (physical)

Payment methods: UPI, Net Banking, Debit / Credit Card, Cash at centre

Step-by-Step Guide

Step 1: Visit the Income Tax e-Filing portal

Open incometax.gov.in and select 'Instant e-PAN' under Quick Links on the homepage.

Step 2: Enter your Aadhaar number

Type your 12-digit Aadhaar, accept the declaration, and continue.

Warning: Instant e-PAN is only for individuals who do not already hold a PAN.

Step 3: Complete Aadhaar OTP e-KYC

Verify the OTP sent to your Aadhaar-linked mobile. Your name, date of birth and address are auto-filled.

Tip: Check the auto-filled spelling carefully — it becomes your permanent PAN record.

Step 4: Confirm and submit

Review the summary page, tick the confirmation box and submit the request.

Step 5: Download your e-PAN

Within about ten minutes the PDF is available under 'Check Status / Download PAN'. It is a legally valid PAN.

Note: The PDF password is your date of birth in DDMMYYYY format.

Common Mistakes

- Applying for a second PAN when one already exists — this attracts a penalty
- Mismatched name spelling between Aadhaar and bank records
- Choosing the physical card option when the free e-PAN is sufficient

Frequently Asked Questions

Is instant e-PAN really free?

Yes. Aadhaar-based instant e-PAN carries no fee. Only physical card issuance

Can I hold two PAN cards?

No. Holding more than one PAN is an offence and can attract a penalty of ₹10,000

Official Portal

<https://www.incometax.gov.in>

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